Class: Reptilia (repere- to crawl or creep)

These vertebrates are fully adapted to live on land. Their body is covered with **horny epidermal scales**. Respiration is through **lungs**. The heart is three chambered with an exemption of crocodiles, which have four-chambered heart. Most of the reptiles lay their eggs with tough outer shell e.g Calotes, Lizard, Snake, Tortoise, Turtle.



Figure 17.16 Calotes

Class: Aves (avis – bird)

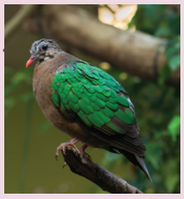
Birds are **homeothermic** (**warm-blooded**) animals with several adaptations to fly. The **spindle** or **boat shaped body** is divisible into head, neck, trunk and tail. The body is covered with **feathers**. **Forelimbs** are modified into **wings** for flight. Hindlimbs are adapted for walking, perching or swimming. The respiration is through lungs, which have **air sacs**. Bones are filled with air (**pneumatic bones**), which reduces the body weight. They lay large yolk laden eggs. They are covered by hard **calcareous shell**. e.g. Parrot, Crow, Eagle, Pigeon, Ostrich .



Figure 17.17 Pigeon

More to Know

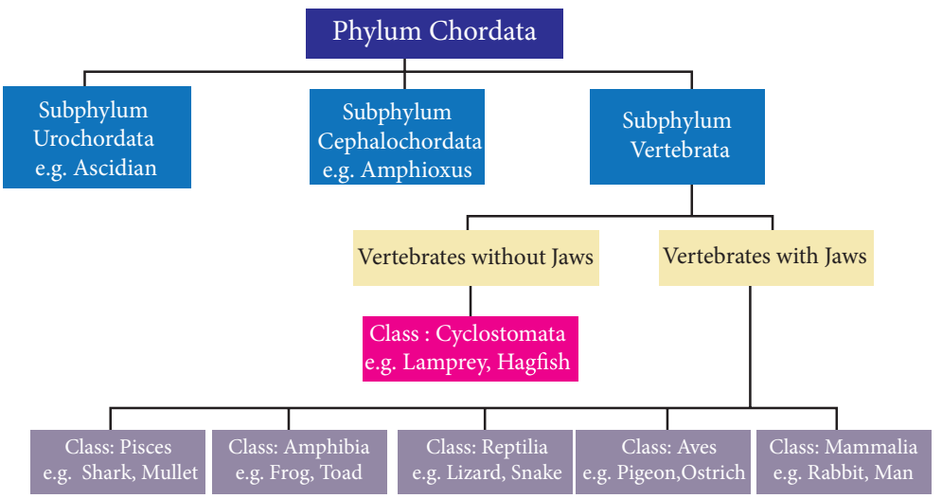
State bird of Tamil Nadu
Common Emerald dove.
(*Chalcophaps indica*)



Class: Mammalia (mamma-breast)

Mammals are **warm-blooded animals**. The skin is covered with **hairs**. It also bears **sweat** and **sebaceous** (oil) glands. The body is divisible into head, neck, trunk and tail. Females have **mammary glands**, which secrete milk for feeding the young ones. The **external ears** or **pinnae** is present. Heart is four chambered and they breathe through lungs. Except egg laying mammals (Platypus, and Spiny anteater), all other mammals give birth to their young ones (**viviparous**). Placenta is the unique characteristic feature of mammals.e.g Rat, Rabbit, Man.

Classification of Phylum Chordata



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